

TOOL

Steps for Choosing The Right Problem

As you begin to map and understand your customer's journey, it is important to choose the right problem for your product to solve. Refer to this tool to help you assess which problems have high potential. While no question will be relevant in all cases, these are important questions to help you clarify your strategy when you develop a new product or make significant changes to an existing product.

Instructions:

1. Identify the problem you want to focus on and fill in the heading below.
2. Consider each question and provide your answers in the space provided.

Problem:

Questions to ask:

- 1** How much pain does your customer experience with this problem today?

- 2** How much impact would you have on your customer's life if you solved the problem well?



- 3 How frequently does your customer experience this pain? Is it daily, weekly, quarterly, yearly? The combination of pain and frequency is a rough gauge for how important the problem is.

- 4 How does your customer currently solve this problem? What are their alternatives to your offering? Alternatives can include anything, including low tech solutions or doing nothing and leaving the problem unsolved.

- 5 What skills, experience, or capabilities does your company need to solve this well? Is your company well positioned to solve it?

- 6 Who else (potential future competitors) is well positioned to solve this problem? Do you think they will attempt to? Why or why not?



- 7 What risks could cause you to fail if you attempt to solve this problem? Do you need to hire a machine-learning expert that you don't currently have on the team? Are you counting on consumers to change their behavior? Are you counting on large companies to trust you? The best product managers take calculated risks, but consider them carefully and don't jump in blindly.

